



It Looks Suspicious!

Level 8 · Reading Champion

Our Sounds

Read every sound out loud before you start the story. Then meet this book's new sounds — they're in colour.

ALL OUR SOUNDS SO FAR

ire	ore	ear	oor
ure	tion	ous	able
ible	cious	tious	

TODAY'S NEW SOUNDS

cious	tious
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SHIFTY SOUNDS



says /s/
as in **face**



says /oo/ short
as in **look**

Story Words

Sound out each phoneme, then blend. Underlines show letters that work together.

d e l i c i o u s
· · · · ·

s u s p i c i o u s
· · · · ·

c a u t i o u s
·

p r e c i o u s
· · ·

n u t r i t i o u s
· · · · ·

s c r u m p t i o u s
· · · · ·

g r a c i o u s
· · ·

a m b i t i o u s
· ·

TRICKY WORDS — TELL YOUR CHILD THESE STRAIGHT AWAY

again

love

WATCH OUT — HOW TO SAY

bruschetta → broo · sket · ta **granita** → gra · nee · ta

limoncello → lee · mon · chell · oh

Luca stood in Nonna's spacious kitchen and crossed his arms. The morning sun streamed through the open window, and the bright clifftop houses of the Amalfi Coast glowed pink and cream outside. Nonna had set a big glass dish on the tiled bench, and inside it sat something green, something red and something Luca did not trust. "What is that?" he asked, taking a cautious step back. "It looks suspicious."



Nonna just smiled. She was a gracious and patient woman who had fed this cautious boy for all of his visits, and she understood him. She picked up a fat, ripe lemon from the tree outside the door — its skin was bright and luscious. She sliced it open, and a sharp, fresh smell burst into the room. Luca sniffed. "That smells... not bad," he admitted, but he remained cautious.



Nonna drizzled green oil over the sliced tomatoes and torn basil leaves. Then she grated fresh lemon rind on top and added a pinch of salt. "This is bruschetta," she said. "It is simple and nutritious." Luca peered at the crusty bread stacked on a plate beside the dish. He picked one up and inspected it. "It looks suspicious," he said again. But the smell was delicious — fresh and bright and sharp.



Next, Nonna filled a big pot with hot water and set it on the stove. She tipped in long strands of fresh pasta and stirred them with a wooden spoon. "Pasta al limone," she announced. "My mother's precious secret — lemon, cream and a sprinkle of pepper." The steam that rose from the pot smelled absolutely delicious, and Luca found himself stepping closer, even though he was still cautious. "I am not eating that," he said, but his feet did not step back.



Nonna set the last dish on the kitchen table: a small glass cup of pale yellow granita, topped with a thin slice of lemon and a mint leaf. "Limoncello granita," she said. "Frozen, sweet and scrumptious. This is the most delicious treat on the Amalfi Coast." Luca looked at the bruschetta, the pasta and the granita. All three smelled delicious, and he had to admit something: he was not just cautious any more — he was also very, very hungry.



He reached out — slowly, carefully — and picked up one small piece of bruschetta. He took the tiniest bite. His eyes went wide. It was delicious. He took a bigger bite, and then another. The fresh tomato and lemon burst across his mouth, and the crusty bread was perfect. He tried the pasta next. It was creamy, sharp and absolutely scrumptious. "Nonna," he said, and his voice was thick with feeling, "this is the most delicious thing I have ever tasted."



The front door clicked open and small feet pattered down the hall. Luca's little sister Sofia ran into the kitchen, her yellow headband bright against her dark curls. She stopped at the table and stared at the granita with a suspicious look on her face. "What is that?" she asked, pointing at the frozen treat. "It looks suspicious!" Luca grinned. He knew those words — he had said them himself, not long before.



Luca picked up the glass of granita and held it out to his sister. "Trust me," he said. "I was suspicious too. But Nonna's cooking is nutritious and delicious — and this is the most precious treat on the whole coast." Sofia took a cautious lick. Her face lit up at once. Nonna watched them from the window, the lemon groves glowing golden on the clifftop behind her, and she thought that feeding the people you love was the most ambitious and delicious thing a person could ever do.

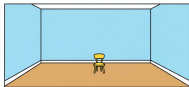


Sound Spotlight

cious



precious



spacious



delicious

tious



cautious



ambitious



infectious



nutritious

Trace & Form the Sounds

Trace the grey letters, then carry on along the line yourself. Say the sound as you write.

cious

c, i, o, u, s: says /shus/

cious

tious

t, i, o, u, s: says /shus/

tious

NOW WRITE EACH WORD

delicious

suspicious

cautious

precious

nutritious

Alien Words Challenge

These aren't real words! Use your phonics to sound them out.

fricious

gricious

stricious

plicious

blicious

drotious

SOUND DETECTIVE

Say each sound, then find and circle it in its words.

ear

says /air/ as in bear

bear

pear

wear

ear

says /ur/ as in learn

learn

earth

heard

Can You Read These?

Sound out each word, then blend it. Use the buttons under each word.

d e l i c i o u s
• • • • •

s u s p i c i o u s
• • • • •

c a u t i o u s
• • • • •

p r e c i o u s
• • • • •

n u t r i t i o u s
• ♦ • • •

s c r u m p t i o u s
• • • • •

READ AND CHOOSE THE WORD

Read each sentence. Which word fills the gap? Circle it.

It was _____.

cautious

ambitious

delicious

"It looks _____."

ambitious

suspicious

nutritious

not bad," he admitted, but he remained _____.

precious

cautious

gracious

Tell the Story

Number the pictures 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6 in the order they happened. Then retell the story out loud in your own words.



Your Turn to Write

Retell what happened in the story. Use the starters and tick a goal as you remember it.

WRITING GOALS — TICK WHEN YOU REMEMBER

- ☐ **Aa** Capital at the start
- ☐ **␣** Finger spaces
- ☐ **. ? !** Correct end mark
- ☐ **↔** Joining word: and / but / because
- ☐ **“ ”** Inverted commas for speech

KEYWORDS — USE THESE IN YOUR RETELL

delicious suspicious cautious precious nutritious
scrumptious

PARAGRAPH RETELL *At first, ... Then, ... In the end, ...*

At first,

Then,

In the end,

Talk About It

FINDING

What three dishes did Nonna make for Luca?

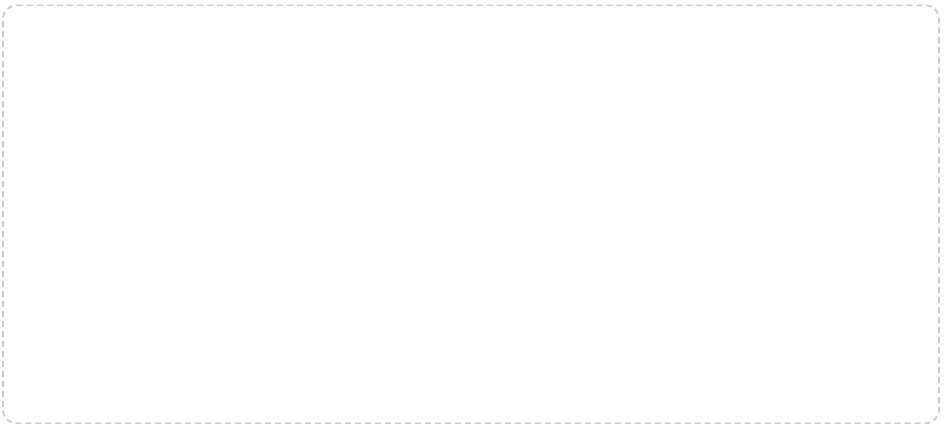
THINKING

Why do you think Luca kept saying the food looked suspicious, even when it smelled delicious?

WORDS

What does 'cautious' mean? Can you think of a time when you were cautious about trying something new?

DRAW YOUR FAVOURITE PART



It made me feel _____

Circle one:



Shifty Sounds — Grow the Code

Different spellings can make the same sound. Read down each column — every spelling underneath makes the sound at the top. The **faded** spellings are still locked: your child meets those in later books, and the chart fills in as they grow.

CONSONANT SOUNDS

s	t	n	m	d	k	r	h	f	j	v	w	z	sh	ch	th ^{thin}	th ^{this}	ng	zh ^{vision}
s	t	n	m	d	k	r	h	f	j	v	w	z	sh	ch			ng	
ss	ed	kn	mb	ed	c	wr	wh	ff	g	ve	wh	zz	ch	tch	th	th	n	s
c		gn			ck			ph	ge			s	ti					si
ce					ch			gh	dge			se	ci					ge
se					que								ssi					
													s					

VOWEL SOUNDS

a	e	i	o	u	ai	ee	igh	oa	oo ^{moon}
a	e	i	o	u	ai	ee	igh	oa	oo
	ea	y	a	o	ay	e	i-e	ow	u-e
				ou	a-e	ea	ie	o-e	ew
					ey	e-e	y	oe	ue
					a	y	i	o	ou
					eigh	ey			ui
					ea	ie			

VOWEL SOUNDS (CONTINUED)

oo ^{book}	ar	or	ur	ow	oi	air	ear	uh ^{butter}
oo	ar	or	ur	ow	oi	air	ear	er
u	a	aw	ir	ou	oy	are	eer	a
ou		au	er			ere	ere	o
		augh	or			ear		our
		ore	ear					re
		oor						
		oar						
		our						

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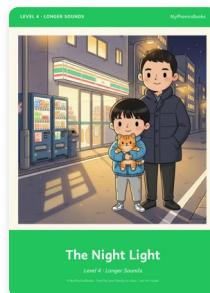
● Level 1



● Level 2



● Level 3



● Level 4



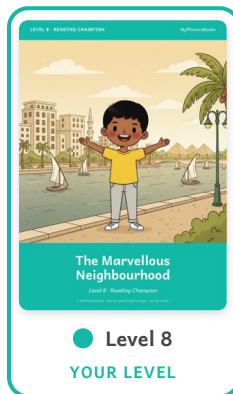
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● Level 8

YOUR LEVEL



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